Connect your domain to your Digital Shop

Step-by-step client guide | v1.0 | Checked 11 October 2026

This guide is for the shop owner editing DNS. Only the Digital Shop superadmin operates the Custom domains page. You do not need superadmin access. We attach the hostname to hosting for you; there is no guaranteed completion time.

Your setup sheet

- Shop name and shop ID: [SHOP_NAME] / [STORE_ID]
- Current shop link: [CURRENT_STORE_URL]
- Website hostname to connect: [CUSTOM_HOSTNAME]
- DNS provider: [DNS_PROVIDER] (the service identified by the current nameservers, not necessarily the registrar)
- Ownership record: TXT / Name [TXT_HOST] / Value [TXT_VALUE]
- Website record: [WEB_TYPE] / Name [WEB_HOST] / Value [WEB_VALUE]
- Requested TTL: 300 seconds (5 minutes), as shown by the feature. If your provider does not offer 300, keep its default/Auto and tell the administrator; do not change unrelated records.
- Final shop test URL: [CUSTOM_SHOP_URL]
- Product test URL: [CUSTOM_PRODUCT_URL]
- Generated: [GENERATED_DATE] / Guide version [GUIDE_VERSION]

Before you start

Domain registration is buying and renewing a name, such as yourshop.in. Hosting is the service that serves your website. Digital Shop uses a Netlify-hosted app for this release. Connecting a domain changes where visitors reach your shop; it does not transfer ownership of your domain, buy a new domain, or move your email.

You keep responsibility for your domain registration and renewal. Netlify-managed Let's Encrypt HTTPS certificates are free and automatically issued/renewed when the hosting and DNS setup is valid. Domain, DNS-provider and Digital Shop plan charges are separate; check your actual plan rather than assuming this feature is free. No price is promised in this guide.

1. Choose the website address

1. For a first connection, prefer a new address such as shop.yourshop.in. This keeps an existing website at yourshop.in or www.yourshop.in separate.
2. Root/apex means yourshop.in; www means www.yourshop.in; a shop subdomain means shop.yourshop.in. They are different hostnames.
3. If you want root or www, ask Digital Shop to review the existing website first. Netlify adds the root/www counterpart when one is added; review both hostnames and redirects before proceeding. Changing either may interrupt your current website.
4. Confirm the exact shop and hostname with the person setting up Digital Shop. Enter only a hostname where a hostname is requested: no https://, no slash and no /store path.

2. Find who actually manages your DNS

1. Sign in to the company where you registered your domain. Open the domain's Nameservers information.
2. Read the nameservers currently in use. They identify the DNS service, which may be different from the company where you bought the domain.
3. Use the account at that DNS service. For example, a domain bought at GoDaddy may use Cloudflare DNS; adding records only at GoDaddy would then have no effect.
4. If you cannot identify the DNS host, send the nameserver names to Digital Shop support. Do not replace nameservers to make this guide work.

Moving your DNS zone to another provider can affect your existing website and email. This guide uses your current DNS service and does not ask you to move nameservers.

3. Save a backup and review the exact host

1. Take a screenshot or export of the current DNS records before editing. Save the old type, host, value and TTL for any record you might change.
2. If this hostname already has A, AAAA, CNAME, parking or forwarding records, stop and have your DNS administrator review them. Save a backup, then replace only conflicts approved for this exact hostname. Leave other hosts, email records and nameservers unchanged.
3. Change only reviewed conflicts for that exact website host. Never delete unrelated MX, SPF, DKIM, DMARC or TXT records. These can support email or other services.
4. Do not disable DNSSEC, remove CAA security rules, change nameservers or turn off another website without a separate review.

4. Get the approved record sheet

1. Ask your Digital Shop administrator to start the connection for the correct shop and hostname.
2. Use the generated ownership TXT record and website DNS instructions. Copy both the Name/Host and Value/Target exactly.
3. The website record must match the confirmed Netlify connection sheet. The provisional targets below must be confirmed by the administrator before publishing.
4. A TXT ownership record proves domain control; it does not send website visitors to your shop. The website record does that. Both checks may be needed.

Record type guide:

- Subdomain: provisional CNAME, Name shop (or your exact approved prefix), Target digital-dukaan-live.netlify.app, requested TTL 300. CONFIRM BEFORE PUBLISHING. No https:// and no /store/shop-name path.
- Root/apex: provisional A, Name @, Value 75.2.60.5, requested TTL 300. CONFIRM BEFORE PUBLISHING. Do not substitute an ALIAS/ANAME/flattened CNAME unless the final sheet explicitly approves it. A normal root CNAME is not the right choice.
- TXT: use the exact generated name and text. Do not replace email TXT records with it. A provider may append your domain automatically; check the final fully qualified name before saving.

5. Add the ownership TXT record

1. Open your DNS records page using the provider steps below. Choose Add record, then TXT.
2. Use the exact generated full name _digitalshop-verify.[CUSTOM_HOSTNAME]. Example only: for shop.example.com, the full name is _digitalshop-verify.shop.example.com. In a DNS zone for example.com that appends the domain, enter _digitalshop-verify.shop. For a root connection, enter _digitalshop-verify. Check the saved full name; do not add the domain twice.
3. Copy the actual generated Value: digitalshop-verify= followed by 48 hexadecimal characters. The phrase "48 hexadecimal characters" and the example hostname are not values to paste. Your personalized sheet supplies the real token.
4. Set TTL 300 if offered; otherwise keep default/Auto and tell the administrator. Save the record.
5. Send the administrator the saved record details. They use "Check again". Keep the record while waiting and follow step 8.
6. The token expires after 7 days. If the administrator sees "The ownership record expired.", they use "New ownership record" and send you a fresh value. Replace only this connection's old verification value, then ask them to check again. Do not keep making new tokens to speed up DNS.

6. Add the website record

1. In the same DNS zone, choose the website record type shown in your setup sheet.
2. Copy the host and target/value exactly. CNAME takes a hostname; A takes an IPv4 address. Do not use URL forwarding or a framed redirect instead.
3. Use TTL 300 if offered; otherwise keep default/Auto and tell the administrator. TTL controls caching, not a promised activation time.
4. For a new Cloudflare shop record, set Proxy status to DNS only, the grey cloud, for the initial setup. Do not change proxy settings for other existing hosts.
5. Save. Check that the final hostname and value match the sheet. If there is a conflict, do not delete records at random; use step 3 and ask for help.

7. Follow your DNS provider's steps

GoDaddy, when GoDaddy nameservers are in use

1. Sign in to GoDaddy Domain Portfolio and select your domain.
2. Open DNS to view records. Select Add New Record, then choose the record Type.
3. For ownership, select TXT. Enter the sheet's Name and Value.
4. If your sheet specifies CNAME for the shop subdomain, select CNAME. Name is the prefix, such as shop; Value is your approved hostname target. For an approved root fallback, select A, Name @, Value the approved IPv4 address.
5. Use TTL 300 if offered; otherwise keep the provider default (GoDaddy documents one hour) and tell the administrator. Select Save, or Save All Records if several new records are shown. Complete GoDaddy's security check yourself if asked.
6. Reopen the record list and check the saved details. If the nameservers are not GoDaddy's, use the actual DNS provider instead.

Hostinger, when Hostinger nameservers are in use

1. Sign in to the Hostinger dashboard. In the left sidebar, open Domains, then DNS.
2. Select your domain. Open DNS / Nameservers, then DNS records if needed.
3. Under Manage DNS records, select TXT and enter the ownership Name and Content. Click Add Record.
4. If your sheet specifies CNAME, add CNAME for the approved shop subdomain. Name is the prefix only; Target is the exact approved hostname. Hostinger adds the domain to the name automatically.

5. Use TTL 300 if offered; otherwise keep the default and tell the administrator. Hostinger's CNAME guidance lists 14400 seconds as a default. Click Add Record. For an approved root A record, use Name @ and the approved IP instead.
6. Check the saved records. If the domain uses other nameservers, changes in Hostinger may not be live; edit at the actual DNS provider.

Cloudflare, when Cloudflare nameservers are in use

1. Sign in to Cloudflare and select your domain's website/zone.
2. Open DNS, then Records. Select Add record.
3. Choose TXT. Fill Name and Content from the ownership sheet; set TTL 300 if offered, otherwise leave Auto and tell the administrator. Save.
4. Select Add record again. If your sheet specifies CNAME, choose CNAME for your shop subdomain, then enter Name and Target. Set Proxy status to DNS only for this new website host. Set TTL 300 if offered, otherwise leave Auto and tell the administrator. Save.
5. For an approved root setup, use the precise flattened-CNAME or A instructions supplied by Digital Shop. Do not improvise a root CNAME at another DNS provider.
6. Check the saved name, target and grey cloud. A proxy can hide the destination during verification. If the existing host already uses Cloudflare protection, get a review before changing it.

Namecheap, when Namecheap DNS is in use

1. Sign in to Namecheap. Open Domain List, then Manage beside your domain.
2. Open Advanced DNS. Under Host Records, choose Add New Record.
3. Choose TXT Record. Enter the ownership Host and Value; use TTL 300 if offered, otherwise keep Automatic and tell the administrator. Save with the green check mark or Save All Changes, as shown in your editor.
4. If your sheet specifies CNAME, add CNAME Record for your shop subdomain. Host is just shop or the approved prefix; Target/Value is the approved hostname. Use TTL 300 if offered, otherwise keep Automatic and tell the administrator. Save.
5. For an approved root setup, use ALIAS or A Record exactly as your sheet specifies, Host @. Do not use an ordinary CNAME at @.
6. If Host Records cannot be edited, check the nameservers: DNS may be managed by another service or your hosting account.

Any other DNS service

1. Open the DNS zone for your registered domain at the service named by its current nameservers.
2. Find Add record. Add the TXT row exactly, save, then add the approved website row.

3. Look for Name/Host, Value/Content/Target and TTL. Labels vary. Use @ only where the sheet/provider says root.
4. If you cannot find a field or the provider rejects the record, ask its support for help adding the supplied row without changing nameservers or email records.

For any of these providers, if your final sheet specifies A or AAAA for a subdomain instead of CNAME, choose that exact type and enter the supplied IPv4 or IPv6 address. Keep the approved host prefix; use TTL 300 if offered, otherwise default/Auto and tell the administrator. Do not add an unapproved IPv6 address.

8. Wait and check DNS

1. Changes can take hours. Allow 24-48 hours depending on your DNS provider and cached records. This is not a promise that the domain will activate in that time.
2. Tell your administrator the records are saved. They use "Check again" on Custom domains to review Ownership, DNS, Hosting and HTTPS separately. They created the connection using "Connect a client's domain" > Select a store > Enter the exact hostname > Review > "Save as pending".
3. If a record has not been found, compare the saved Name and Value with your setup sheet. Check that you edited the authoritative DNS service from step 2.
4. Avoid making new edits just to speed up propagation. Ask support to check the authoritative answer and cached answers if the record still does not match after the waiting period.

9. Wait for hosting and HTTPS separately

1. We attach the hostname to hosting for you. Netlify then issues a Let's Encrypt certificate when the DNS and hosting setup is valid. The administrator may use "Start HTTPS setup". You do not need to buy a certificate or attach the alias yourself.
2. "Pending DNS" means records still need checking. "Verifying" means checks are running. "Provisioning HTTPS" means HTTPS setup is in progress. "Server setup required" means the administrator must finish hosting setup; do not change correct DNS just to clear this state.
3. "Ready to activate" is not "Live". All five required checks must pass, including the intended-store check. Only then can the administrator use "Activate". "Live" is the confirmed active state.
4. "Needs attention" means a check needs review. "Disconnected" means the connection is disconnected. Step results are "Verified", "Pending", "Failed", "Not checked" or "Server setup required". Your administrator can explain which step is affected.
5. DNS verification and HTTPS readiness are separate waits. A pending certificate is not proof that DNS is wrong. Never bypass a browser certificate warning. Keep the old shop link until the administrator confirms Live.

6. If HTTPS stays pending, ask the administrator to check Netlify certificate status, all required aliases, proxy settings and CAA restrictions. Do not remove security records yourself. No activation deadline is guaranteed.

10. Test the correct shop

1. Open the final HTTPS shop URL from your setup sheet in a private browser window.
2. Check the shop name, products and contact details. A page that opens is not enough: it must be your shop, not another shop or a generic Digital Shop page.
3. Open the supplied product deep link. Refresh that page directly and confirm it still shows the same shop and product.
4. Test from another connection, such as mobile data, if possible. Confirm there is no certificate warning and no unexpected redirect to a different shop.
5. Keep using your old Digital Shop link until the administrator confirms the connection is ready. Do not place a paid test order just to check the domain.

11. Fix a problem without breaking other services

- Ownership TXT not found: check the exact TXT name/token, including whether the provider added the domain twice. Use the current token from the sheet. Ask support if a different person or account already owns the connection.
- Wrong DNS host/value: make sure CNAME points to the approved hostname, not a URL, IP address or /store path. Make sure A uses the approved IP, and your host is the intended prefix, not a doubled domain name.
- Old website or parked page: review old A/AAAA, CNAME, parking and forwarding entries for this exact web host. Back them up and replace only approved conflicts. Other hosts and email records stay untouched.
- DNS changes not visible: confirm nameservers and the DNS account you edited, then allow for caches. Editing at the registrar is not enough if DNS is elsewhere.
- Proxy/CDN masking: ask support to review proxying for this website host. For a new Cloudflare pilot record, DNS only makes the destination visible. Do not disable protection for other hosts.
- HTTPS pending or certificate error: DNS waiting and TLS waiting need different checks. Ask support to check Netlify HTTPS validation and CAA. A restrictive CAA rule may need a reviewed addition allowing letsencrypt.org; do not delete all CAA rules or disable DNSSEC.
- Domain already connected/ownership conflict: do not remove someone else's assignment. Send the hostname and exact error to Digital Shop; the administrator must resolve ownership or the old mapping safely.

- Wrong shop opens: stop sharing the address and use your old link. DNS may be correct but the app's host-to-shop mapping may be wrong. Ask Digital Shop to check the store ID and mapping; do not try to fix it by changing email or nameservers.

Messages your administrator may report

- "The ownership record was not found yet.": check the TXT full name/value and authoritative DNS, then allow for caches.
- "The ownership record expired.": get the fresh value after "New ownership record"; change only this verification record.
- "DNS points somewhere other than the Digital Shop server.": compare the saved website type/host/value with the confirmed sheet.
- "No DNS records found for this hostname yet.": check the provider and exact hostname; do not create unrelated records.
- "This domain is already connected to another store.": the administrator must review the existing assignment; do not remove another shop's connection.
- "HTTPS is not ready yet.": wait for hosting/HTTPS checks; this is separate from DNS propagation.
- "The HTTPS certificate is not valid for this hostname.": do not bypass the warning; the administrator checks certificate coverage.
- "The domain does not show the intended store.": stop sharing it and use your old link; ask the administrator to check the shop mapping.
- "The check timed out. Result unknown.": this is not a confirmed success or failure; the administrator uses "Check again".

12. Roll back, disconnect or ask for help

1. If a reviewed DNS change broke the old website, use the saved records from step 3 to restore only the rows changed for this website host, with your DNS administrator. Restoring the whole zone can overwrite working email or later changes.
2. Restoring DNS takes time to reach caches too. Keep the old Digital Shop link available and ask the administrator to pause or disconnect the custom-host mapping if needed.
3. For a normal disconnect, the administrator chooses "Disconnect", types the required hostname confirmation and uses "Disconnect domain". The confirmation says the store, products and orders are not changed. Afterward, remove only the DNS records for this connection at your DNS provider, or restore its reviewed previous website records. Disconnecting in Digital Shop does not edit your DNS automatically. Do not cancel the domain registration or delete the whole DNS zone to disconnect a shop.

4. For help, send the hostname, shop name/ID, DNS provider, exact status/error, time of the last change and a cropped screenshot of the relevant record's Type, Name, Value and TTL. Include proxy status if applicable.
5. Hide unrelated domains, billing details, account email and personal details. Never send a password, API key, login code, recovery code or private certificate key. Share only the public verification record if support needs it.

Provider screen labels can change; the generated record sheet remains the source for your exact values.

Official help sources

Checked 11 October 2026. These links explain DNS/HTTPS and provider editors. The Digital Shop token format, expiry, actions and states are application-specific, not defined by these public help pages.

- Netlify external DNS https://docs.netlify.com/manage/domains/configure-domains/configure-external-dns
- Netlify domain aliases https://docs.netlify.com/manage/domains/configure-domains/add-a-domain-alias
- TXT records and domain ownership / TXT और डोमेन नियंत्रण https://www.cloudflare.com/learning/dns/dns-records/dns-txt-record/
- Netlify automatic HTTPS / अपने आप HTTPS https://docs.netlify.com/manage/domains/secure-domains-with-https/https-ssl/
- CAA and Let's Encrypt / CAA और Let's Encrypt https://letsencrypt.org/docs/caa/
- TTL and caching / TTL और कैश https://developers.cloudflare.com/dns/manage-dns-records/reference/ttl/
- DNS propagation / DNS बदलाव का समय https://www.godaddy.com/help/what-factors-affect-dns-propagation-time-1746
- GoDaddy TXT https://www.godaddy.com/en/help/add-a-txt-record-19232
- GoDaddy CNAME https://www.godaddy.com/en/help/add-a-cname-record-19236
- Hostinger DNS https://www.hostinger.com/support/1583249-how-to-manage-dns-records-at-hostinger/
- Cloudflare DNS https://developers.cloudflare.com/dns/manage-dns-records/how-to/create-dns-records/index.md
- Namecheap DNS https://www.namecheap.com/support/knowledgebase/article.aspx/434/2237/how-do-i-set-up-host-records-for-a-domain/